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LANGUAGES

German (Native)

English (B2)

Christian Erben

I have many years of experience in system and network administration, with a focus on designing and securing complex, redundant infrastructures. This includes professional firewall management, planning secure network architectures, as well as solid knowledge of classic and advanced protocols and platforms. Additionally, I bring extensive practice in Linux administration, security-oriented operational processes, and the establishment of structured security mechanisms such as IAM, ISMS, as well as incident and vulnerability management.

PROFILE

As an experienced IT engineer with over 18 years of practice in enterprise environments, I combine deep technical expertise with a clear focus on information security and robust operational processes. My focus lies on designing, operating, and securing complex network and platform architectures. This includes in particular firewall management, planning secure and segmented networks, as well as extensive knowledge of both classic and exotic network protocols and various network products.

In addition to my network experience, I have been working intensively with Linux systems for many years and manage both classic server environments and containerized platforms. I combine this technical foundation with structured approaches from information security management, the development of security policies, and the establishment of effective security processes.

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE / GOVERNANCE

Information Security Management (ISMS)

- Establishment and maintenance of security policies (Policies, SOPs, procedures)
- Derivation and implementation of organizational and technical security measures
- Continuous development of secure operational processes

Security Governance

- Definition and establishment of security standards for infrastructure and platform operations
- Documentation, process design and ensuring uniform policy application
- Creation and maintenance of security-relevant operating concepts

BSI IT-Grundschutz

- Use of Grundschutz methodology to structure and evaluate security measures
- Support in establishing secure operational processes according to recognized standards

Identity & Access Management (IAM)

- Role and permission concepts (RBAC)
- Rights review, recertification and separation of functions
- Privileged Access Management (PAM)

Incident & Vulnerability Management

- Establishment and maintenance of structured processes for incidents & security findings
- Prioritization, processing and documentation of security-relevant incidents
- Operational vulnerability management (including patch planning and follow-up)

EXPERIENCE

Key Projects

Core technical and organizational engagements with high responsibility.

IT Consultant specializing in IPv6

Public-sector client May 2026 - Present

Remote / Germany

- Technical consulting on IPv6 readiness of IT systems and applications.
- Assessment of technical prerequisites and support in planning adjustments.
- Support for technical testing and documentation of results.
- Coordination of technical matters with the teams involved.

IPv6 | Technical Analysis | Quality Assurance | Documentation

Network Security / Management

Deutsche Vermögensberatung AG Oct 2019 - Present

Frankfurt am Main, Germany

- Manage and review network permissions to maintain accurate, secure access controls across the enterprise.
- Continuously clean up legacy rules to reduce complexity and ensure compliance with internal policies.
- Support IT projects with network expertise, ensuring architectures align with current topologies and security standards.
- Maintain detailed network documentation covering topology, policies, and security protocols.
- Coordinate change planning and implementation with infrastructure, security, and application teams.
- Operate proxy infrastructures and monitor network paths including IPSec tunnels and SD-WAN links.
- Support the introduction of cloud-based security services such as Prisma SSE.
- Responsible for Identity & Access Management (IAM) and rights review in enterprise environments
- Creation and maintenance of security-relevant processes and documentation
- Ensuring consistent policy application in complex network and infrastructure environments
- **Achievement: Reduced firewall rule complexity from 5,000 to fewer than 1,000 entries for greater transparency and performance.**
- **Achievement: migration from Palo Alto to Fortinet, translating complex security policies without service interruption.**
- **Achievement: Implementation of IPv6 across the organization, future-proofing the network.**
- **Achievement: Rolled out secure SD-WAN connectivity for branch offices, improving stability and visibility of network communication.**
- **Achievement: Introduced Microsoft Azure services into the infrastructure while ensuring compliant hybrid connectivity.**

Firewall Management | SD-WAN | IPSec | Proxy | Azure | IPv6 | Change Management | Documentation | Cloud Security

Network & Security Engineer - Migration to Fortinet

St. Dominikus Krankenhaus und Jugendhilfe gGmbH Sep 2026 - Sep 2026

Remote / Ludwigshafen, Germany

- Migration of the existing Cisco and Palo Alto environment to Fortinet.
- Transfer of firewall rules, network objects, NAT and routing configurations, and existing VPN connections.
- Review of existing configurations and migration of current functionality and security policies to the Fortinet platform.
- Cutover planning and execution, with functional testing of network connections, VPN access, and connected systems.
- Troubleshooting during the migration and documentation of the migrated configurations.

Fortinet | Cisco | Palo Alto | Firewall Migration | VPN | NAT | Routing

Network Administrator (Palo Alto / Fortinet)

St. Dominikus Krankenhaus und Jugendhilfe gGmbH Feb 2026 - Apr 2026

Ludwigshafen, Germany

- Responsible for high availability and secure operation of LAN, WLAN, and VPN services for medical and administrative environments.
- Operate and maintain network infrastructure including switches, routers, firewalls, and VLAN segmentation for different hospital areas.
- Implement security controls and policies aligned with ISO 27001, BSI baseline protection, GDPR, and sector-specific requirements.
- Monitor network performance and fault tolerance for critical systems and provide rapid troubleshooting in incident scenarios.
- Integrate medical devices into hospital network environments and ensure secure interoperability with clinical information systems.
- **Achievement: Currently migrating IPSec VPN tunnels from Cisco to Palo Alto with phased cutover planning and no service disruption.**

Palo Alto | Fortinet | LAN/WLAN/VPN | VLAN Segmentation | ISO 27001 | BSI Baseline Protection | GDPR | IDS/IPS | Zero Trust | Healthcare IT

Linux Systems Administrator / Nagios Administrator

Schwarz IT GmbH & Co. KG Apr 2018 - Dec 2018

Weinsberg, Germany

- Operated large-scale environments with 15,000 physical servers and 50,000 virtual machines.
- Automated provisioning of servers, applications, and configurations via Puppet and Ansible.
- Ensured high availability through structured patch management and monitoring.
- Advised projects on secure infrastructure design and integration into existing monitoring processes.
- **Achievement: Accelerated server rollout cycles by automating golden-image provisioning and compliance checks.**

Linux | Automation | Monitoring | High Availability | Puppet | Ansible | IPv6

Linux Systems Administrator

Deutsche Vermögensberatung AG Feb 2011 - Dec 2017

Frankfurt am Main, Germany

- Administered 1,000 physical servers and 2,000 virtual machines in a highly regulated environment.
- Automated server installation and configuration workflows using Puppet and Ansible.
- Operated enterprise email platforms with Dovecot and Postfix including archiving solutions.
- Implemented storage solutions such as Ceph and cloud storage for scalable data services.
- **Achievement: Delivered a mail archiving platform that ensured long-term compliance and simplified eDiscovery.**
- **Achievement: Design and implementation of IPv6 at the network perimeter to ensure external accessibility.**

Linux | Email | Automation | Storage | Puppet | Ceph | IPv6

Additional Projects

Complementary or specialized projects with flexible scope.

Member of the Board

DEGIT AG Apr 2020 - Present

Hockenheim, Germany

- Board member focusing on data protection, information security, and network strategy for SME clients.
- Connects clients with specialists from DEGIT's expert network and coordinates interdisciplinary consulting teams.
- Oversees the design of secure, redundant infrastructures including firewall concepts, VPN solutions (IPv6, Zero Trust, Zero-Config VPN, etc.) and backup strategies.
- Introduction of a company-wide security governance framework including policy design and access governance
- Conducting structured risk analyses and deriving technical security measures
- Development of secure operational processes (Least Privilege, Logging, Monitoring, Role Models)
- **Achievement: Established a governance framework aligning network security, privacy, and compliance requirements for new customer projects.**

Compliance | Security Strategy | Networking | Consulting | Compliance | M365 | Cloudflare | Supabase | Azure | IPv6

SchlauFabrik – Multi-tenant Compliance & AI Training Platform

xtensible UG (haftungsbeschränkt) & Co. KG December 2025 - Present

Hockenheim, Germany

- Designed and built a modern, responsive training platform for compliance and AI topics (SME-focused) with tenant isolation and role-based access.
- Implemented security-by-design with Postgres Row-Level Security, audit logging, rate limiting, and hardened authentication flows (Passkey/Magic Link/2FA/SSO).
- Built course delivery with progress tracking, quizzes, enrollments, and admin dashboards for tenant/user management.
- Delivered tamper-evident PDF certificates with QR verification and cryptographic hashing; enabled bulk export for audits.
- Integrated Stripe billing (subscriptions, portal, webhooks) with license models and soft-lock mechanisms for tenant limits.
- Tech: Next.js (App Router), TypeScript, Bun, Tailwind, next-intl (DE/EN), Neon Postgres, Stripe, Resend, Vitest/Playwright.

Multi-tenant | Compliance | AI Training | RBAC | Postgres RLS | Stripe | Next.js | TypeScript | Tailwind | Neon Postgres | Vitest | Playwright

AI Training Platform & AI Tools Evaluation

DEGIT AG Aug 2025 - Oct 2025

Hockenheim, Germany

- Design and implementation of an internal AI training platform for corporate use, focusing on compliance with the EU AI Act and practical enablement of teams.
- Evaluation and decision paper comparing leading AI and automation platforms with regard to data protection, reliability, API integration, and governance readiness.
- Assessment of emerging agentic AI workflows for multi-step task orchestration and their integration into enterprise automation environments.
- **Achievement: Analyzed and benchmarked: OpenAI ChatGPT, OpenAI Open-Weight GPT-OSS, Microsoft Copilot, Perplexity, Anthropic Claude, Apple Foundation, z.AI GLM, n8n, make.com, Zapier.**
- **Achievement: Developed a modular learning platform prototype with Supabase and Cloudflare integration, role-based content, and progress tracking.**
- **Achievement: Produced a comparative decision framework supporting the company's AI adoption strategy.**

AI Evaluation | AI Training | EU AI Act | Supabase | Cloudflare | Automation | n8n | make.com | Zapier | OpenAI | Apple Foundation | Anthropic Claude | Microsoft Copilot | Perplexity | z.AI GLM | Agentic AI | Enterprise Automation | Cursor | Claude Code | OpenAI Codex

SKILLS & TECHNOLOGIES

Security

Firewall Engineering (Fortinet, Palo Alto) | Proxy Management | Secure Web Gateways | Access Governance | Change Governance | Incident Management | Problem Management

Infrastructure

Linux Administration | Linux Distributions (Debian, Ubuntu, RHEL) | High Availability | Redundancy & Failover | IPv6 & Routing | VPN & Secure Connectivity | Monitoring | Troubleshooting

Tools & DevOps

Bash / Shell Scripting | paperless-ngx | Git | Cursor | Postfix / Dovecot | Bind / Unbound | Squid Proxy | HAProxy | Docker | Caddy

Management

Change Management | Cross-team Coordination | Stakeholder Communication | Technical Documentation

AI

AI-assisted Troubleshooting | Agentic AI | Multimodal AI | Causal AI | Lovable | OpenAI / ChatGPT | Anthropic / Claude | Google / Gemini | AI Ethics & Governance

Compliance

Regulatory IT Compliance | Audit-Readiness & Policy Enforcement | Financial Sector Control Environments

HIGHLIGHTED PROJECTS

Firewall Rulebase Optimisation

Streamlined enterprise firewall rulebases by analysing 5,000+ objects, consolidating duplicates, and establishing a lifecycle for dormant rules. The result improved performance, readability, and audit readiness.

Firewall | Governance | Automation

Palo Alto to Fortinet Migration

Planned and executed a platform migration, translating complex objects and policies into Fortinet while keeping services online. Introduced new templates for ongoing policy hygiene.

Migration | Fortinet | Change Management

SD-WAN Branch Rollout

Connected branch offices via SD-WAN, defined redundancy concepts, and aligned monitoring to ensure transparent operations across all paths.

SD-WAN | Networking | Monitoring

Azure Integration for Hybrid Infrastructure

Introduced Microsoft Azure services into an on-prem environment, coordinating network connectivity, identity integration, and security baselines.

Azure | Hybrid Cloud | Security